

HOW NOT TO BE NERVOUS IN IELTS SPEAKING:

Expert Tips and Strategies

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Helping you Become a Confident English Speaker

Many IELTS students lack confidence in their speaking skills.

The Keith Speaking Academy helps you develop your speaking skills so you can face the examiner with confidence and ace the IELTS test.

This PDF is one of many that Keith has developed to help you do this.



Keith has been working in international education for over 20 years as a teacher, teacher trainer, and education manager.

He has helped over 40,000 students prepare for their IELTS Speaking test with his online courses.

Feeling nervous before the IELTS Speaking test is a common experience for many students. However, understanding how to manage these nerves is essential if you want to do well in the test.

In this PDF I want to give you a complete guide with some great tips on how to overcome nervousness in the IELTS Speaking test.



Understanding Nervousness

Nervousness is an automatic body response to stress or uncomfortable situations. It causes you to release adrenaline, your heart rate and breathing will increase, and potentially affect your focus.

Recognising that nervousness is both normal and temporary can be reassuring. It's crucial to control your nerves to speak clearly, maintain a good pace, focus on accuracy, and stay on topic during your test.



Strategies to Overcome Nervousness

1. Prepare for the Worst, Expect the Best

Anticipate the worst result of the test, so as to mentally prepare yourself, but shift your focus to the best possible outcomes. This mindset helps manage expectations and reduces anxiety.

2. Practice Being Nervous

Put yourself in uncomfortable situations to get accustomed to the feeling of nervousness. This could include speaking up in classes, asking questions at conferences, or engaging in conversations with strangers.

3. Preparation and Realistic Goals

Being well-prepared reduces nervousness. Set realistic goals for your IELTS score improvement and familiarise yourself with the test format and common topics. Enhancing your general English skills and flexibility in speaking about various subjects is also vital. All of this preparation will help build confidence and reduce nerves.

4. Believe in Your English

Own your English skills proudly, regardless of your current level.
Confidence in your abilities can significantly impact your performance.

5. Techniques for Immediate Pre-test Preparation

- **Call a Friend:** Briefly chatting with a friend before the test can reduce the feeling of isolation and negative thoughts.
- **Practice Positive Posture:** Adopting a confident posture can trick your mind into feeling more confident.
- **Visualisation:** Imagine a successful test experience, focusing on positive interactions and outcomes.
- **Let the Nerves Be:** Accept your nervousness without fighting it. Allow yourself to feel your nerves, allow them to be. Just say, “I am nervous, and that’s ok.” Then see what happens.
- **The 3-3-3 Rule:** Focus on three things you see, three sounds you hear, and three parts of your body you can feel. This mindfulness technique helps bring you into the present moment, reducing anxiety.

6. On Test Day

- **Focus on Communication:** Initially, prioritise clear communication over showcasing your language skills.
- **Share Your Emotions:** Expressing emotions during your responses can enhance fluency and engagement.
- **See the Examiner as a Person:** Humanising the examiner can reduce intimidation and foster a more natural conversation.
- **Breathe, Smile, Enjoy:** Remember to breathe deeply, smile to build rapport, and adopt a positive attitude towards the test.

7. Remember the Examiner's Perspective

Most examiners are rooting for you to succeed. They are not looking to trick you but want to see you communicate effectively in English.

Conclusion

Managing nervousness in the IELTS Speaking test is about preparation, mindset, and practical strategies before and during the test.

Try some of these tips and see which ones work best for you. Hopefully, they will help you approach your IELTS Speaking test with greater confidence and poise. Remember, practice and positivity are key to overcoming nervousness and achieving your desired score.



Find out more information about IELTS Speaking here:

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